

She became his indispensable partner, both emotionally and professionally.

A vibrant new world

By the mid-1920s, Rodrigo's music was being performed in Valencia and Madrid. In 1927, he left Spain with Ibáñez for Paris, to study under the composer Paul Dukas at the Ecole Normale de Musique. Here, he was also introduced to the vibrant Parisian literary and musical culture, and met the composer Manuel de Falla, who became a lifelong friend, mentor, and champion of his work.

After studying musicology at the Paris Conservatoire and the Sorbonne, Rodrigo traveled around Europe in the 1930s, composing and performing as a concert pianist. It was then that he met Turkish pianist Victoria Kamhi, whom he married in 1933. In 1941, they had a daughter, Cecilia, named after the patron saint of musicians.

Rodrigo was absent from Spain during the Spanish Civil War (1936–1939); in 1939, he and Victoria were living in Paris. But, aware of impending conflict in Europe, they moved to Madrid before World War II began. Rodrigo took with him the *Concierto de Aranjuez* for guitar and orchestra, which he had written in Paris and that secured his international reputation.